Minara Safaris

LIMITED

Product Feature Specification

A complete definition of the web platform and mobile application — tours, safaris, worldwide hotel booking, a built-in travel wallet, and the operations back office that runs it all.

Safari & Tour Packages | Parks & Permits | Global Hotel Booking | Travel Wallet | Multi-Currency | Agent Portal | Mobile Apps | Operations Console

DOCUMENT	PREPARED FOR	SCOPE	STATUS
Feature Requirements v1.0	**Minara Safaris Ltd**	**Web Platform & Mobile Apps**	**For Review**

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HOW TO READ THIS DOCUMENT

Every feature is tagged with the release it belongs to: LAUNCH PHASE 2 PHASE 3 FUTURE. Launch items form the smallest complete product that can take real money from real travellers. Later phases add depth, automation and scale. Nothing in this document assumes a particular technology — it describes behaviour, not implementation.

SECTION 01

Executive Summary

Minara Safaris is building a global travel platform: a destination brand for African safaris and curated tours, combined with a worldwide hotel booking engine and a travel wallet that lets customers save, pay and be refunded inside one account.

The product in one paragraph

A traveller anywhere in the world discovers Minara Safaris, browses safari packages and tours, searches hotels in any city, builds a trip, pays in their own currency, and manages everything afterwards from an account and a mobile app. Behind that, the Minara team runs a full operations console — inventory, bookings, suppliers, payments, refunds and reporting. Around it sit two more audiences: suppliers who own the lodges and vehicles, and travel agents who resell Minara trips for commission.

Four products, one platform

1 · The Public Platform

The website and mobile app the world sees. Discovery, search, booking, payment, wallet, and post-booking self-service for travellers in any country.

2 · The Operations Console

The internal system the Minara team lives in every day. Bookings, customers, inventory, pricing, payments, refunds, supplier coordination and reporting.

3 · The Supplier Portal

A limited, self-service area for lodges, hotels, camps, transport partners and guides to manage their own availability, rates and assigned jobs.

4 · The Agent Portal

A business-to-business channel where travel agencies book on behalf of clients at agent rates, track commissions and pull their own statements.

What success looks like

0	1	24/7	100%
Bookings that require a phone call to complete	Place where all money movement is visible	Self-service across every timezone	Of trips manageable from a phone

Guiding principles

- **Book without contact.** A traveller in Berlin at 2am must be able to complete and pay for a trip with nobody at the office awake. Human contact is an option, never a requirement.
- **The wallet is the spine.** Deposits, instalments, refunds, credits, promotions and agent commissions all settle through one ledger, so the money story is always complete and auditable.
- **Nothing is hardcoded.** Packages, prices, seasons, pages, images, taxes, currencies and policies are all managed by staff through the console — never by a developer.

- **Local everywhere.** Prices in the customer's currency, dates in their format, communication in their language and timezone.
- **Mobile is not a smaller website.** The app does things the website cannot: offline itineraries, live trip updates, boarding-style day cards, and location-aware guidance in the bush.
- **Every state is recoverable.** Abandoned carts, failed payments, expired holds and cancelled bookings all leave a clear trail and a path back.

SECTION 02

Users & Roles

The platform serves five distinct audiences with very different needs and very different levels of access. Getting these boundaries right early prevents most of the security and usability problems that appear later.

Audience map

AUDIENCE	WHO THEY ARE	WHAT THEY NEED MOST
Traveller	Individuals, couples, families and groups booking leisure travel from anywhere in the world.	Confidence that the trip is real, clarity on total price, and the ability to pay and change plans without friction.
Corporate Client	Companies booking staff travel, retreats and incentive trips.	Invoicing, approval flows, cost centres, multiple travellers per booking, consolidated statements.
Travel Agent	Third-party agencies and independent consultants reselling Minara trips.	Net rates, fast quoting, commission visibility, the ability to book for a named client.
Supplier	Lodges, hotels, camps, car-hire firms, guides and activity operators.	Simple availability and rate control, clear job assignments, prompt settlement.
Minara Staff	Reservations, operations, finance, marketing and management.	One console with total visibility and the tools to intervene on any booking at any stage.

Staff permission levels

Internal access is role-based, and roles are assignable per person rather than baked in. A person may hold more than one role.

ROLE	CAN DO	CANNOT DO
Reservations Agent	Create, amend and cancel bookings; talk to customers; issue vouchers; take payments.	Change pricing rules, issue refunds above a threshold, view full financial reports.
Operations	Assign vehicles, guides and drivers; confirm supplier bookings; manage day-of-travel logistics.	Touch pricing or customer payment details.
Finance	Reconcile payments, approve refunds and payouts, manage currency and tax settings, export accounting data.	Edit public content or package descriptions.
Content / Marketing	Edit pages, packages, imagery, blog posts, promotions and campaigns.	See customer payment data or booking financials.
Manager	Everything above plus approvals, overrides, discount authority and full reporting.	—
Administrator	Create staff accounts, assign roles, configure the platform, view the audit log.	—

REQUIREMENT

Every action that changes money, availability or customer data is written to an **audit log** recording who did it, when, what changed from and to, and from where. The log is readable by administrators and cannot be edited or deleted by anyone.

Account and access features

- Self-registration for travellers by email, phone number, or a social/Google sign-in. LAUNCH
- Guest checkout that later converts into a full account without losing the booking. LAUNCH
- Email and phone verification, password reset, and secure session handling across devices. LAUNCH
- Two-factor authentication — mandatory for all staff and supplier accounts, optional for travellers. LAUNCH
- Staff invitation flow: administrators invite by email, the invitee sets their own credentials, no shared logins. LAUNCH
- Session and device management — a user can see active sessions and sign out remotely. PHASE 2
- Single sign-on for corporate clients. FUTURE

SECTION 03

Public Website

The public site does three jobs: make a stranger believe Minara is real and excellent, help them find the right trip fast, and hand them to checkout without hesitation.

Home page

- Full-bleed hero with rotating destination imagery and a prominent, always-visible search bar. LAUNCH
- A unified search entry point with tabs for **Safaris & Tours**, **Hotels**, and **Custom Trip**. LAUNCH
- Featured packages, seasonal collections and "trips leaving soon" strips, all editable by staff. LAUNCH
- Destination tiles by country and region, leading to curated destination pages. LAUNCH
- Trust band: licences and memberships, years operating, traveller count, review score, payment badges. LAUNCH
- Latest reviews and video testimonials. LAUNCH
- Newsletter capture and a soft lead-capture offer such as a downloadable trip guide. PHASE 2
- Personalised recommendations for returning visitors based on what they viewed or saved. PHASE 3

Destination pages

- One rich page per country, region, park or city — Kenya, Tanzania, Uganda, Rwanda, Zanzibar, Dubai, and onwards. LAUNCH
- Overview narrative, photo gallery, interactive map, and a "best time to visit" month-by-month chart. LAUNCH
- Practical panel: visa requirements, vaccinations, currency, language, plug type, safety notes, typical costs. LAUNCH
- All packages and hotels available in that destination, filterable inline. LAUNCH
- Wildlife and attraction highlights — for safari destinations, migration timing and species likelihood by month. PHASE 2
- Weather and climate data pulled live. PHASE 2

Company and trust pages

- About, our story, team profiles with photos, and office locations. LAUNCH
- Why book with Minara — differentiators, guarantees, and what is included as standard. LAUNCH
- Responsible and sustainable tourism: conservation partners, community projects, carbon position. LAUNCH
- Frequently asked questions, organised by topic and searchable. LAUNCH
- Booking terms, cancellation policy, privacy policy, cookie policy and travel insurance guidance. LAUNCH

- Contact page with enquiry form, WhatsApp link, phone numbers by region, and office hours in the visitor's timezone. LAUNCH
- Careers and supplier-partnership application pages. PHASE 2
- Press and media kit with downloadable logos and imagery. PHASE 3

Editorial and inspiration

- Blog and travel guides with categories, tags, author profiles and related-article suggestions. LAUNCH
- Every article can link directly to bookable packages, turning inspiration into conversion. LAUNCH
- Traveller story features with photo galleries. PHASE 2
- Downloadable resources: packing lists, itineraries in PDF, destination guides. PHASE 2

Cross-cutting behaviour

- Fully responsive from small phones to large desktops; the site is designed mobile-first. LAUNCH
- Accessible to screen readers and keyboard navigation, with sufficient colour contrast throughout. LAUNCH
- Search-engine optimised: clean URLs, page titles and descriptions per page, structured data for tours, hotels, prices and reviews, sitemap, and social sharing previews. LAUNCH
- Cookie consent and regional privacy banners that adapt to the visitor's jurisdiction. LAUNCH
- Live chat widget with handoff to a human during office hours. LAUNCH
- Site-wide search across packages, hotels, destinations and articles. PHASE 2

SECTION 04

Safari & Tour Catalogue

The catalogue is the heart of the brand. Each package must be rich enough to sell itself, and structured enough to price, schedule and operate without ambiguity.

What a package contains

ELEMENT	DETAIL HELD
Identity	Name, subtitle, unique code, destination(s), duration in days and nights, difficulty or pace level.
Story	Overview narrative, highlights list, who it suits, what makes it different.
Itinerary	Day-by-day breakdown: title, description, meals included, accommodation for the night, driving distance and time, activities.
Inclusions	Explicit lists of what is included and, equally importantly, what is excluded.
Media	Gallery images with captions, hero image, video embeds, downloadable PDF itinerary, route map.
Pricing	Per-person rates by season and occupancy, child rates by age band, single supplement, group discounts.
Availability	Fixed departure dates, or open availability with blackout periods; capacity per departure.
Options	Selectable upgrades — accommodation tier, private vs shared vehicle, extra nights, optional excursions.
Policy	Deposit percentage, balance due date, cancellation and amendment terms, minimum group size.
Practical	Fitness requirements, visa and vaccination notes, packing guidance, age restrictions.

Package types supported

Fixed Departure

Set dates with limited seats. Shows remaining capacity, fills up, and closes automatically. Ideal for group safaris and small-group tours.

Day Trips & Excursions

Short single-day products with time slots, pickup points and instant confirmation.

Private / On-Demand

Available on any date the customer chooses, subject to blackout dates and lead time. Priced by group size.

Multi-Country Circuits

Itineraries spanning several countries with border crossings, internal flights and multiple suppliers coordinated as one booking.

Browsing and search

- Filter by destination, duration, price range, travel month, trip style (wildlife, beach, culture, honeymoon, family, adventure, luxury), accommodation level and group size. LAUNCH
- Sort by popularity, price, duration, departure date, or rating. LAUNCH
- Map view showing where each package goes. PHASE 2
- Side-by-side comparison of up to four packages. PHASE 2
- Save to wishlist, and share a package or wishlist by link, email or WhatsApp. LAUNCH
- Recently viewed strip and "travellers also looked at" suggestions. PHASE 2

The package detail page

- Immersive gallery, sticky price-and-book panel, and a clear total for the selected dates and party. LAUNCH
- Expandable day-by-day itinerary with accommodation links and map. LAUNCH
- Live availability calendar showing which dates are open, filling, or sold out, and price by date. LAUNCH
- Party selector for adults, children with ages, and room configuration. LAUNCH
- Optional extras selected inline with the price updating instantly. LAUNCH
- Reviews specific to that package, with photos. LAUNCH
- "Ask a question" and "request a call back" without leaving the page. LAUNCH
- Similar and alternative packages if dates are unavailable. PHASE 2
- Price-drop and availability alerts by email. PHASE 3

SECTION 05

Parks, Reserves & Permits

Park access is where safari operations become genuinely difficult. Fees change with a traveller's nationality, permits are quota-limited and sell out months ahead, and a mistake at the gate ruins the day. The platform treats parks as first-class, priced, bookable inventory rather than a footnote on an itinerary.

Park and reserve directory

Every park, reserve, conservancy and protected area Minara operates in has its own managed record and public page — the national parks and game reserves of Kenya, Tanzania, Uganda, Rwanda and beyond, alongside private conservancies, marine parks and mountain reserves.

- Overview, size, landscape and ecosystems, and what the park is known for. LAUNCH
- Gates and entry points with locations, opening and closing hours, and which gate suits which route. LAUNCH
- Wildlife present, with likelihood of sighting by season — including the flagship species travellers come for. LAUNCH
- Best time to visit, month by month, covering weather, wildlife density, crowds and price. LAUNCH
- How to get there: road distance and realistic driving time from the nearest city, airstrips served, and internal flight options. LAUNCH
- Accommodation inside the park and in the surrounding area, linked directly to bookable inventory. LAUNCH
- Every activity bookable within the park, linked to the activity catalogue. LAUNCH
- Park rules made explicit before arrival: speed limits, off-road policy, drone restrictions, single-use plastic bans, minimum ages for certain activities, and what happens if rules are broken. LAUNCH
- Map with gates, game-viewing circuits, rivers, lodges and airstrips. PHASE 2
- Seasonal closures and road conditions — some circuits and camps become unreachable in heavy rain and must stop selling automatically. PHASE 2
- Park-level capacity and crowding indicators to steer travellers toward quieter alternatives. PHASE 3

Park fees and charges

This is the single most error-prone area in safari pricing, and it must be computed by the system rather than remembered by a person.

- **Residency tiers.** Separate rates for citizens, East African residents and non-residents, applied automatically from each traveller's nationality and country of residence. LAUNCH
- **Age bands.** Adult, child, infant and student rates with the exact age thresholds each park uses, evaluated against the traveller's age on the date of entry rather than the date of booking. LAUNCH

- **Charging basis.** Support for per-person-per-day, per-entry, and fixed-validity fees, with correct handling of multi-day and re-entry scenarios. LAUNCH
- **Vehicle entry fees** by seat capacity and registration origin, including surcharges on foreign-registered vehicles. LAUNCH
- **Conservancy and community levies** held separately from government park fees, since they are set by different bodies and change independently. LAUNCH
- **Camping and concession fees** — public campsites, special campsites, bed-night levies and crater or concession service charges. LAUNCH
- **Seasonal fee variation** where a park charges differently in high and low season. LAUNCH
- **Dated fee schedules.** Every fee is stored with the period it applies to, and the system always uses the rate valid on the travel date — so an announced increase can be entered ahead of time and takes effect on its own. LAUNCH
- Automatic re-pricing whenever the party, ages, nationalities or dates change. LAUNCH
- Transparent presentation of which fees are included in the trip price and which are payable at the gate, so nobody is surprised on arrival. LAUNCH
- Park-fee reporting: total fees collected and remitted, by park and period. PHASE 2

> **WHY THIS IS A SYSTEM PROBLEM**
>
> A family of four holding three different nationalities, entering two parks on a shared vehicle over five days, generates a fee calculation no one should be doing by hand. Getting it wrong either loses margin or leaves the traveller with an unexpected bill at the gate. Both are avoidable.

Permits and quota-limited access

Some experiences are hard-capped by the authority that issues them. These behave like a completely different kind of inventory — scarce, dated, non-transferable and unforgiving.

- Gorilla trekking permits, sold by date and by sector, against a fixed daily quota. LAUNCH
- Chimpanzee tracking and habituation experience permits. LAUNCH
- Mountain climbing permits with route selection and dated hut or camp allocation. LAUNCH
- Marine park, birding and special-access permits. PHASE 2
- Permits held as dated, strictly limited stock that **cannot be oversold** under any circumstances, including simultaneous bookings. LAUNCH
- Traveller name, passport number, age and nationality captured to a hard deadline, because permits are issued to named individuals. LAUNCH
- Permit-specific cancellation and transfer rules, which are normally far stricter than the rest of the trip and must be shown separately at checkout. LAUNCH
- Low-availability and sold-out warnings with alternative dates and sectors offered immediately. LAUNCH
- Issued permit documents attached to the booking and delivered to the traveller. LAUNCH
- Permit stock forecasting so Minara can pre-purchase against expected demand. PHASE 3

Activities inside the parks

Game viewing

- Morning, mid-morning, afternoon, full-day and night game drives
- Private vehicle or shared seat, with a window-seat guarantee
- Guided bush walks and walking safaris with an armed ranger
- Rhino and big-cat tracking with conservation teams

Signature experiences

- Balloon safaris with dawn departure and strict capacity
- Boat, canoe and launch safaris
- Bush breakfasts, sundowners and bush dinners
- Photographic hides and specialist birding outings

Beyond the park gate

- Cultural visits to communities bordering the parks
- Conservation and research centre visits
- Mountain trekking and multi-day hiking routes
- Coastal and marine extensions after a safari

How each is sold

- Time slot, duration and departure point
- Minimum and maximum participants
- Age, fitness and health restrictions
- What is included, what to bring, and what to wear

Vehicles, guides and park logistics

- Vehicle type matched to the park — pop-up-roof four-wheel drive, open-sided game viewer, or closed van — with the right choice enforced rather than assumed. LAUNCH
- Seat allocation on shared game drives, with capacity tracked per departure. LAUNCH
- Guides assigned by park specialisation, language and certification level. LAUNCH
- Realistic inter-park driving times built into itinerary planning, so a circuit cannot be sold that is impossible to drive. LAUNCH
- Gate entry and exit logging so operations know where every vehicle is in the day. PHASE 2
- Communication and emergency procedure recorded per park, including nearest medical facility and evacuation options. LAUNCH
- Fuel, mileage and long-transfer planning between parks. PHASE 2
- Ranger and escort requirements where a park mandates them. PHASE 2

Wildlife and seasonality

- A migration and wildlife calendar per park showing what is happening in each month — herd movement, calving, river crossings, breeding and bird migration. PHASE 2
- Recommendation of parks and dates based on what the traveller most wants to see. PHASE 2
- Sighting likelihood by species and season, set honestly rather than optimistically. PHASE 2
- Traveller-facing sighting log during the trip, feeding an aggregate view of what is currently being seen where. PHASE 3

Conservation

- The conservation and community levy shown as a transparent, named line on every park booking rather than buried in the total. LAUNCH
- Named conservation and community partners per park, with what the levy funds. LAUNCH
- Optional traveller donation at checkout, receipted separately. PHASE 2
- A post-trip statement of what the traveller's booking contributed. PHASE 3
- Carbon estimate for the itinerary with an offset option. PHASE 3

SECTION 06

Global Hotel Booking Engine

Beyond safaris, Minara sells accommodation worldwide. This is a distinct product with its own search behaviour, inventory model and confirmation flow — and it must feel as fast and familiar as any major booking site.

Two sources of inventory

Direct Inventory

Properties Minara contracts directly — partner lodges, camps and hotels. Minara controls rates, allocation and cancellation terms, and margins are highest.

- Managed in the console or by the property itself in the supplier portal
- Room-type level allocation and stop-sells
- Instant confirmation where allocation exists

Aggregated Inventory

Global hotel supply drawn from wholesale bed-bank and channel partners, giving worldwide coverage from day one without contracting every property.

- Live rate and availability lookup at search time
- Markup rules applied automatically by Minara
- Booking, modification and cancellation passed through

Both sources appear in one blended result list. The traveller never needs to know which is which; the console always does.

Search

- Destination input with type-ahead across cities, regions, landmarks, airports and individual property names. LAUNCH
- Date range picker with flexible-date option (±3 days) and nights-only mode. LAUNCH
- Occupancy builder: multiple rooms, adults and children per room, children's ages captured for correct pricing. LAUNCH
- Results with photo, star rating, review score, distance from centre or chosen landmark, headline amenities and lead price per night and total. LAUNCH
- Filters: price range, star rating, guest rating, board basis (room only, bed & breakfast, half board, full board, all inclusive), property type, amenities (pool, wifi, parking, gym, spa, airport shuttle, family rooms, accessible rooms, pet friendly), neighbourhood, and free cancellation only. LAUNCH
- Sort by recommended, price, rating, distance or popularity. LAUNCH
- Map view with price pins and draw-your-own-area search. PHASE 2
- Results load progressively so the first hotels appear immediately rather than after every source has responded. LAUNCH
- Saved searches and price alerts. PHASE 3

Property detail page

- Full gallery, description, location map, and distances to key points of interest. LAUNCH

- Complete amenity list grouped by category, plus property policies: check-in and check-out times, children and extra beds, pets, smoking, accepted payment on site, required documents. LAUNCH
- Room list, one row per rate plan, each showing bed configuration, occupancy, board basis, cancellation policy, and total price for the stay. LAUNCH
- Clear labelling of refundable versus non-refundable rates, and any pay-at-property versus pay-now distinction. LAUNCH
- Guest reviews with sub-scores for cleanliness, location, service, value and facilities. LAUNCH
- Nearby alternatives if the property is full for the chosen dates. PHASE 2
- Photo tagging by room type so guests see the specific room they are buying. PHASE 2

Rates, taxes and rules

- Multiple rate plans per room type, each with its own price, board basis, cancellation window and restrictions. LAUNCH
- Seasonal rate calendars with date-range pricing and day-of-week variation. LAUNCH
- Minimum and maximum length of stay, closed-to-arrival and closed-to-departure rules. LAUNCH
- Occupancy-based pricing including child rates by age band and extra-bed charges. LAUNCH
- Automatic separation of taxes, city or tourism levies, resort fees and service charges — shown transparently before payment, with a clear indication of what is payable at the property. LAUNCH
- Configurable markup rules by source, destination, property or rate plan. LAUNCH
- Promotional rate plans: early-bird, last-minute, long-stay, non-refundable discount. PHASE 2
- Loyalty and member-only rates. PHASE 3

Booking a hotel

1
Select rate
Room and rate plan chosen; price locked briefly while the guest completes details.

2
Guest details
Lead guest and any named occupants, special requests, arrival time.

3
Payment
Full payment, deposit, or wallet balance — depending on the rate rules.

4
Confirmation
Voucher issued with property contact details and confirmation reference.

- Special requests field passed through to the property (late arrival, high floor, twin beds, honeymoon). LAUNCH
- Instant confirmation where the source supports it; clearly-communicated on-request status where it does not. LAUNCH
- Self-service cancellation and date change within policy, with the refund calculated and shown before the customer commits. LAUNCH
- Voucher available as PDF, in the app, and by email — in the guest's language. LAUNCH

SECTION 07

Transport, Flights & Extras

A trip is more than a bed and a game drive. These ancillary products raise the value of every booking and remove the need for the traveller to organise anything themselves.

Airport transfers and ground transport

- Bookable transfers by route, with vehicle class (sedan, SUV, minivan, safari vehicle, luxury), passenger and luggage capacity, and per-vehicle or per-person pricing. LAUNCH
- Flight number capture so drivers can track arrival delays. LAUNCH
- Meet-and-greet options, name-board service, and child seat requests. LAUNCH
- Point-to-point and hourly-hire chartering. PHASE 2
- Driver assignment, live journey status and traveller-visible driver details before pickup. PHASE 2
- Vehicle rental with or without a driver, including insurance options and licence capture. PHASE 3

Flights

- Domestic and regional bush-flight legs sold as part of a package, with schedules, baggage limits and operator details. LAUNCH
- Flight-inclusive package pricing, where the internal air legs are priced into the trip. LAUNCH
- International flight search and booking as a standalone product. PHASE 3
- Traveller-supplied flight details for arrival and departure coordination, even when Minara did not sell the flight. LAUNCH

Activities and experiences

- Bookable standalone activities: balloon safaris, cultural visits, diving, city tours, cooking classes, park entries. LAUNCH
- Time-slot and capacity management, pickup point selection, and minimum participant rules. LAUNCH
- Add-on prompts at checkout and after booking — "travellers on this safari also added". PHASE 2

Travel services

- Travel insurance offered at checkout, with cover levels, price by traveller age and trip value, and policy documents. PHASE 2
- Visa assistance products and e-visa guidance by nationality and destination. PHASE 2
- Airport lounge access, eSIM data packs and currency-exchange partners. PHASE 3
- Gift experiences: honeymoon extras, birthday arrangements, private dinners, photography sessions. PHASE 2

SECTION 08

Custom Trip Builder

A large share of high-value safari business is tailor-made. The platform must let a traveller describe what they want, and let Minara turn that into a priced, bookable, payable itinerary without leaving the system.

The traveller side

- A guided enquiry flow: destinations of interest, travel dates or flexibility, number and ages of travellers, budget band, accommodation style, interests, special occasions, and free-text notes. LAUNCH
- The option to start from an existing package and request changes to it. LAUNCH
- Immediate acknowledgement with an expected response time in the traveller's own timezone. LAUNCH
- A shareable enquiry link so travelling companions can contribute to the brief. PHASE 3
- Self-service drag-and-drop itinerary assembly from a catalogue of days, lodges and activities. FUTURE

The proposal

- Staff build a proposal in the console by assembling days, accommodation, transport and activities, with costs pulled from contracted rates. LAUNCH
- Automatic margin calculation showing cost, markup and sell price side by side, internal-only. LAUNCH
- Multiple options presented in one proposal — for example Classic, Premium and Luxury versions of the same route. LAUNCH
- Proposal delivered as a branded web page the client can view on any device, plus a matching PDF. LAUNCH
- The client can comment on specific days, request changes, and approve an option directly from the proposal. LAUNCH
- Version history so both sides can see what changed between revisions. PHASE 2
- Proposal expiry dates, view tracking, and automated follow-up reminders. PHASE 2
- One-click conversion of an approved proposal into a live booking with a deposit request. LAUNCH
- A library of reusable itinerary templates and building blocks to speed up quoting. PHASE 2

> **WHY THIS MATTERS**
>
> Tailor-made enquiries are where the highest margins live, and where most operators lose deals to slow response times. Every hour saved between enquiry and proposal is a measurable increase in conversion.

SECTION 09

Booking & Reservation Engine

The engine that turns a selection into a commitment. It must handle multi-item trips, hold inventory safely, survive interruptions, and remain correct when two people try to buy the last seat at the same moment.

Cart and multi-item trips

- A single booking can contain a safari package, several hotel stays, transfers, activities and extras — priced and paid as one. LAUNCH
- The cart survives across sessions and devices for a signed-in user. LAUNCH
- Each item is validated for availability again immediately before payment. LAUNCH
- Timed inventory holds while the traveller completes checkout, with a visible countdown and automatic release. LAUNCH
- Conflict detection — the system warns if two items overlap in date or if there is not enough time between a flight and a transfer. PHASE 2

Checkout

1	2	3	4	5
Review	**Travellers**	**Terms**	**Pay**	**Confirm**
Full itemised trip summary and total, in the chosen currency.	Names, ages, passport data, dietary and medical notes, emergency contact.	Cancellation policy, insurance recommendation, explicit acceptance recorded.	Deposit, full balance, wallet, or instalment plan.	Reference issued, documents generated, suppliers notified.

- Guest checkout with no forced account creation, and a one-click account claim afterwards. LAUNCH
- Progress is saved at every step; a dropped connection never loses entered data. LAUNCH
- Promotional code entry with instant validation and clear rejection reasons. LAUNCH
- Abandoned-checkout recovery by email with a link straight back to the saved cart. PHASE 2

Booking lifecycle

STATUS	MEANING	WHAT HAPPENS NEXT
Enquiry	Interest captured, nothing held or owed.	Staff respond with a quote or proposal.
Quoted	A priced offer exists with an expiry date.	Client accepts, requests changes, or it lapses.
Provisional	Inventory held for a limited window, no payment yet.	Auto-expires and releases unless a deposit is paid.
Confirmed	Deposit received, suppliers notified, trip is committed.	Balance reminders scheduled.
Paid in Full	Balance settled before the due date.	Final documents released.
Travelling	Trip is in progress.	Day-of-travel support and live updates.
Completed	Trip finished.	Review request, supplier settlement, repeat-booking offer.
Cancelled	Ended by either party.	Refund calculated per policy, inventory released.

Amendments and cancellations

- Traveller-initiated date changes, party-size changes and cancellation, each showing the exact financial consequence before confirmation. LAUNCH
- Automatic cancellation-fee calculation based on the policy and how close the departure is. LAUNCH
- Staff override with a mandatory reason, recorded in the audit log. LAUNCH
- Amendment fees, price re-quoting when rates have moved, and difference collection or refund. LAUNCH
- Partial cancellation — removing one traveller or one hotel from a multi-item booking. PHASE 2
- Transfer of a booking to another person or to a future date as credit. PHASE 2

Documents generated

- Booking confirmation with full itinerary and reference number. LAUNCH
- Invoice and receipt for every payment, tax-compliant for the customer's region. LAUNCH
- Accommodation and activity vouchers with supplier contact details. LAUNCH
- A complete travel pack issued before departure: itinerary, vouchers, emergency contacts, packing list, arrival instructions and a map. LAUNCH
- All documents branded, available as PDF, downloadable from the account and the app, and re-sendable by staff. LAUNCH

SECTION 10

Payments & Checkout

Selling globally means accepting money the way each market prefers to pay it. A customer who cannot use their normal payment method will not simply switch — they will leave.

Payment methods

METHOD	MARKETS	NOTES
Cards — Stripe	Worldwide	Visa, Mastercard, American Express and regional card schemes via **Stripe**; 3-D Secure authentication where required; saved cards for repeat purchase.
M-Pesa	East Africa	**M-Pesa** mobile money — payment prompted to the customer's handset, confirmed automatically and reconciled against the booking reference without staff intervention.
Digital Wallets	Worldwide	Apple Pay, Google Pay and PayPal — one-tap checkout on mobile, delivered through Stripe where supported.
Bank Transfer	Worldwide	Local and international transfer with reference matching; essential for high-value trips.
Regional Methods	Europe, Asia	SEPA Direct Debit, iDEAL, Bancontact, Alipay, WeChat Pay and similar, enabled through Stripe as each market demands.
Buy Now, Pay Later	Selected markets	Klarna, Afterpay and equivalents via Stripe, for lower-value bookings.
Wallet Balance	Worldwide	Pay from the Minara travel wallet, in full or in part, alone or combined with any method above.

Payment structures

- **Full payment** at the time of booking. LAUNCH
- **Deposit plus balance** — a percentage or fixed amount now, the rest by a due date calculated from the departure. LAUNCH
- **Instalment plans** — the total split across scheduled dates, automatically charged, with reminders and retries on failure. PHASE 2
- **Pay-later holds** — inventory reserved with payment due within a fixed window. LAUNCH
- **Split payment across travellers** — each member of a group pays their own share via a personal payment link. PHASE 2
- **Corporate invoicing** — book now, pay on agreed credit terms, with statements and credit-limit enforcement. PHASE 2

The two payment rails

Stripe — the global rail

Handles every non-African payment and all card traffic worldwide.

- Cards, wallets and regional methods from one integration
- Strong Customer Authentication and 3-D Secure handled automatically
- Settlement in multiple currencies, reducing conversion loss
- Built-in fraud scoring and dispute handling
- Payouts for wallet withdrawals and supplier settlement
- Card details tokenised by Stripe and never stored by Minara

M-Pesa — the East African rail

The dominant payment method across Kenya and the region, and non-negotiable for local and regional travellers.

- Customer-initiated and platform-initiated payment prompts
- Automatic confirmation and matching to the booking reference
- Paybill and till payments captured and reconciled
- Refunds and wallet withdrawals paid back to the customer's number
- Transaction status polling so a delayed confirmation never strands a booking

Both rails feed the same booking and wallet ledger, so the source of a payment never changes how a booking behaves. Adding a third provider later must not require reworking the booking flow.

Handling money correctly

- Every payment attempt is recorded with its outcome, provider reference, method, amount, currency and exchange rate at the time. LAUNCH
- Failed payments produce a clear, human explanation and a retry path, not a dead end. LAUNCH
- Duplicate-payment protection so a double-click or a browser refresh never charges twice. LAUNCH
- Automatic reconciliation of incoming funds against bookings, with an exceptions queue for anything unmatched. LAUNCH
- Refunds issued back to the original method where possible, or to the wallet where not, with full traceability. LAUNCH
- Partial refunds, and refunds spanning several original payments. LAUNCH
- Chargeback and dispute tracking with evidence attachment. PHASE 2
- Card details are never stored on Minara systems; tokenisation is handled entirely by the payment provider. LAUNCH

Pricing transparency

- The total price shown at the first opportunity, with taxes, fees and any payable-at-property amounts broken out. LAUNCH
- Currency conversion clearly labelled, with the rate and the charging currency stated before payment. LAUNCH
- No surprise fees introduced late in checkout. LAUNCH

SECTION 11

The Travel Wallet

The wallet is what distinguishes Minara from a conventional booking site. It gives travellers a place to save toward a trip, absorbs refunds without friction, and gives the business a clean, auditable ledger for every unit of value moving through the platform.

What the wallet does for the traveller

Save toward a trip

Top up any amount, any time, from any supported payment method — then draw on it when booking. Especially powerful for customers saving over months for a once-in-a-lifetime safari.

Hold multiple currencies

Separate balances per currency, so a customer who topped up in euros is not exposed to conversion loss when they book.

Instant refunds

Cancellations and amendments credit the wallet immediately instead of waiting days for a card refund to clear — and the money stays within Minara.

Receive rewards

Referral bonuses, loyalty credit, goodwill gestures and promotional value all land in the wallet as spendable balance.

Wallet features

- A wallet is created automatically with every account; no separate signup. LAUNCH
- Top up by card or digital wallet through Stripe, by M-Pesa, or by bank transfer — with a minimum and maximum per transaction. LAUNCH
- Balance displayed prominently in the account and the app, with per-currency breakdown. LAUNCH
- Full transaction history — every credit and debit with date, description, related booking, method and running balance. LAUNCH
- Downloadable wallet statement as PDF or spreadsheet for any date range. LAUNCH
- Pay for a booking fully or partially from the wallet, with the remainder taken by another method. LAUNCH
- Withdraw unused balance back to an M-Pesa number or a bank account, subject to verification and policy. LAUNCH
- Currency conversion between wallet balances at a transparent, stated rate. PHASE 2
- **Savings goals** — name a target trip and amount, see progress, and set an automatic recurring top-up. PHASE 2
- **Gift the wallet** — a third party can send credit to a traveller for a honeymoon, birthday or wedding registry. PHASE 2
- **Group trip pot** — several people contribute to a shared balance that funds one group booking, with each contribution visible. PHASE 3

- Wallet-to-wallet transfer between verified accounts. PHASE 3
- Interest or bonus credit on balances held toward a booked trip. FUTURE

How the ledger works

Every movement of value is a double-entry record. A balance is never edited directly — it is always the sum of its transactions, which makes reconciliation exact and disputes resolvable.

TRANSACTION	EFFECT	TRIGGERED BY
Top-up	Credit	Customer adds funds by any payment method.
Booking payment	Debit	Wallet used to pay for a trip, deposit or balance.
Refund credit	Credit	Cancellation, amendment or overpayment returned as balance.
Promotional credit	Credit	Campaign, goodwill gesture or compensation issued by staff.
Referral reward	Credit	Referred friend completes a qualifying booking.
Withdrawal	Debit	Customer moves balance out to a bank or mobile money account.
Transfer in / out	Credit / Debit	Gift received or sent between accounts.
Adjustment	Either	Manual correction by finance — always requires a reason and approval.
Expiry	Debit	Promotional credit reaching its expiry date, where policy allows.

Controls and safeguards

- Identity verification required before withdrawal above a configurable threshold. LAUNCH
- Configurable limits: maximum balance, maximum top-up per day, maximum withdrawal per period. LAUNCH
- Withdrawals reviewed and approved by finance before release, with a queue and an approval trail. LAUNCH
- Wallet freeze and unfreeze by an administrator, with reason recorded, in cases of suspected fraud or dispute. LAUNCH
- Separation of promotional credit from real money, so bonuses can carry restrictions (non-withdrawable, expiring, minimum-spend). LAUNCH
- Alerts to the customer on every wallet movement, by email and push. LAUNCH
- Customer funds held distinctly from operating funds, with reporting that shows total outstanding wallet liability at any moment. LAUNCH
- Anti-money-laundering screening on unusual patterns — rapid top-up and withdrawal without booking, for instance. PHASE 2

> **REGULATORY NOTE**
>
> Holding customer money is regulated differently in different jurisdictions. The platform must treat wallet balances as a **liability**, keep them fully reconcilable at all times, and support the record-keeping and reporting a regulator or auditor would expect. Legal advice should be taken on licensing before wallet withdrawals are opened in each market.

The business side of the wallet

- A finance dashboard showing total wallet liability, top-ups, spend, refunds and withdrawals over any period. LAUNCH
- The ability to issue credit to any customer wallet with a reason, subject to an approval threshold. LAUNCH
- Bulk credit issuance for campaigns or service-recovery situations. PHASE 2
- Supplier and agent wallets using the same ledger — commissions and settlements accrue as balance and are paid out on a schedule. PHASE 2
- Full export of the ledger for accounting systems. LAUNCH

SECTION 12

Traveller Account

Once someone has booked, the account becomes their trip headquarters — the place they return to for documents, payments, changes and answers.

Trip dashboard

- A countdown to the next trip with a live checklist of outstanding items — balance due, passport details missing, insurance not added, forms unsigned. LAUNCH
- Upcoming, past and cancelled bookings, each opening to the full itinerary. LAUNCH
- Day-by-day itinerary view with accommodation, activities, transfers and free time. LAUNCH
- All documents and vouchers in one place, downloadable at any time. LAUNCH
- Payment summary: what has been paid, what remains, when it is due, and a button to pay now. LAUNCH
- Request a change or cancellation, with the cost consequence shown before submitting. LAUNCH
- Message thread with the Minara team attached to the specific booking. LAUNCH

Traveller profile

- Personal details, contact information, nationality and residence. LAUNCH
- Passport details with expiry-date warnings ahead of travel. LAUNCH
- Dietary requirements, allergies, medical notes, mobility needs and emergency contacts — stored once and applied to every booking. LAUNCH
- Travel companions saved as a party, so repeat bookings do not require re-entry. PHASE 2
- Preferences: currency, language, communication channel, room and bed preference, seat preference. LAUNCH
- Secure document uploads — passport scan, visa, vaccination certificate, insurance policy. LAUNCH
- Marketing consent management, granular by channel. LAUNCH
- Data download and account deletion request, satisfying privacy law. LAUNCH

Beyond the booking

- Wishlist of saved packages and hotels, shareable with companions. LAUNCH
- Wallet access with full balance and history. LAUNCH
- Review submission for completed trips, with photo upload. LAUNCH
- Referral link with tracking of who has signed up and what has been earned. PHASE 2
- Loyalty tier with progress, benefits and points history. PHASE 3
- Trip memories — a private page with the itinerary, photos and stats after the trip. FUTURE

SECTION 13

Mobile Application

Native applications for iOS and Android. The app is not a copy of the website — it earns its place by being useful in the field, where connectivity is poor and the traveller needs their itinerary in their hand.

Before travel

- Browse, search and book everything available on the website, optimised for touch. LAUNCH
- Biometric sign-in with fingerprint or face recognition. LAUNCH
- Wallet: balance, top-up, history and payment, with one-tap payment methods. LAUNCH
- Trip countdown, preparation checklist and document upload from the phone camera. LAUNCH
- Push notifications for balance due, document requests, and booking confirmations. LAUNCH
- Add trip dates to the phone calendar. LAUNCH

During travel — the differentiator

Offline itinerary

The full trip, all vouchers, maps and contacts downloaded to the device and readable with no signal at all — essential in national parks and remote camps.

Live updates

Flight delays, driver assignment and arrival, schedule changes and weather alerts pushed as they happen.

Today view

A single card for the current day: what is happening, when, where, who is collecting you and what to bring.

One-tap help

Emergency contacts, the 24-hour Minara support line, local emergency numbers and the nearest hospital — always reachable.

- Offline maps of parks, routes and lodge locations. PHASE 2
- Digital vouchers presentable at check-in without printing. LAUNCH
- In-app chat with the trip coordinator. LAUNCH
- Wildlife sighting log and species guide for safari guests. PHASE 3
- Photo journal that builds automatically as the trip progresses. PHASE 3
- Currency converter and tipping guidance for the destination. PHASE 2
- Language phrasebook for the destination. PHASE 3

After travel

- Review and rating prompt with photo upload. LAUNCH

- Trip summary and shareable highlights. PHASE 2
- Personalised suggestions for the next trip, with a returning-traveller offer. PHASE 2

App fundamentals

- Available on the Apple App Store and Google Play, supporting current and recent OS versions. LAUNCH
- Graceful behaviour on slow and intermittent connections; nothing is lost when the signal drops. LAUNCH
- Deep links so an email or shared link opens the right screen in the app. LAUNCH
- Same language and currency support as the website. LAUNCH
- Accessibility support including dynamic text sizing and screen readers. LAUNCH
- In-app update prompts and remote configuration so behaviour can change without a store release. PHASE 2

SECTION 14

Operations Console

The internal system where the business is actually run. If the console is weak, the team works in spreadsheets and email — and the data on the website stops being true.

Command centre

- Live dashboard: today's arrivals and departures, bookings made, revenue, payments received, pending actions and alerts. LAUNCH
- Action queues that demand attention — unconfirmed bookings, overdue balances, expiring holds, unassigned vehicles, unanswered enquiries, failed payments, refund approvals. LAUNCH
- Global search across bookings, customers, enquiries, invoices and suppliers by any identifier. LAUNCH
- Per-user task list and assignment, so nothing falls between people. PHASE 2

Booking management

- Full booking record: itinerary, travellers, payments, documents, supplier bookings, messages and complete change history. LAUNCH
- Create a booking manually on behalf of a customer, including phone and walk-in bookings. LAUNCH
- Amend any element — dates, party, accommodation, extras — with automatic re-pricing and a clear difference to collect or refund. LAUNCH
- Apply a discount or waive a fee within the operator's authority level. LAUNCH
- Take a payment over the phone via a secure link sent to the customer, never by reading card numbers aloud. LAUNCH
- Resend any document, regenerate vouchers, and add internal notes visible only to staff. LAUNCH
- Booking calendar and list views with saved filters per user. LAUNCH
- Bulk actions across selected bookings — send a message, export, or update a status. PHASE 2

Customer management

- Unified customer record: profile, all bookings, lifetime value, wallet balance, all communications, preferences and notes. LAUNCH
- Duplicate detection and record merging. PHASE 2
- Segmentation by destination interest, spend, recency, nationality and channel. PHASE 2
- Enquiry pipeline with stages, ownership, follow-up reminders and conversion tracking. LAUNCH
- Complaint and incident logging with resolution tracking. PHASE 2

Inventory, rates and content

- Create and edit packages, itineraries, hotels, room types, rate plans, transfers and activities. LAUNCH

- Seasonal pricing calendars with bulk editing across date ranges. LAUNCH
- Departure management: create dates, set capacity, watch fill rates, close out or open up. LAUNCH
- Allocation and stop-sell management for contracted properties. LAUNCH
- Markup and commission rules by product, source, market and partner. LAUNCH
- Cost management — what Minara pays each supplier — with automatic margin display. LAUNCH
- Preview any product exactly as a customer will see it, before publishing. LAUNCH
- Duplicate an existing package as the starting point for a new one. LAUNCH
- Bulk price adjustment — for example, raise all Kenya rates by a percentage for next season. PHASE 2

Operations and logistics

- Daily operations sheet: every movement happening today and tomorrow, with vehicle, driver, guide, pickup time and passenger list. LAUNCH
- Resource assignment for vehicles, drivers and guides, with conflict warnings when double-booked. LAUNCH
- Supplier booking requests sent, tracked and confirmed within the system rather than by loose email. LAUNCH
- Rooming lists and manifests generated per departure. LAUNCH
- Fleet register with vehicle details, capacity, service dates and insurance expiry. PHASE 2
- Guide and driver register with languages, specialities, certifications and availability. PHASE 2
- Live vehicle tracking during trips. PHASE 3

Finance

- All payments and refunds in one ledger, filterable by method, currency, date and status. LAUNCH
- Reconciliation against provider settlements and bank statements, with an exceptions queue. LAUNCH
- Refund approval workflow with thresholds and a second approver above a set amount. LAUNCH
- Supplier invoices, payables and payment scheduling. PHASE 2
- Agent commission accrual and payout runs. PHASE 2
- Wallet liability reporting and withdrawal approvals. LAUNCH
- Currency, exchange-rate and tax configuration. LAUNCH
- Export to accounting software. PHASE 2

Configuration

- Staff accounts, roles and permissions. LAUNCH
- Cancellation policies, deposit rules and payment terms as reusable, named policies applied to products. LAUNCH

- Email, SMS and notification templates editable by staff with live preview. LAUNCH
- Currencies, languages, tax rates and regional settings. LAUNCH
- Company details, branding, logos and document footers. LAUNCH
- Audit log viewer with search and filter. LAUNCH

SECTION 15

Supplier & Property Portal

Lodges, hotels, camps, transport firms and guides get a narrow, self-service window into the platform. This removes a huge volume of email and phone coordination from the operations team.

For accommodation partners

- Manage their own property profile: description, photos, amenities, policies and contact details, subject to Minara approval before publishing. PHASE 2
- Availability calendar — open and close dates, set allocation, apply stop-sells. PHASE 2
- Rate management by room type, rate plan and season. PHASE 2
- View incoming bookings, guest names, special requests and arrival details. PHASE 2
- Confirm or decline on-request bookings within a response window. PHASE 2
- Statements of what is owed, what has been paid and what is pending. PHASE 2

For transport and activity partners

- Job board of assigned transfers, tours and activities with date, time, passengers and pickup location. PHASE 2
- Accept or decline assignments, and nominate the driver or guide performing the job. PHASE 2
- Mark a job started and completed, with notes and incident reporting. PHASE 3
- Upload documents — licences, insurance certificates, vehicle inspections — with expiry tracking and reminders. PHASE 2

Shared supplier features

- Secure login with two-factor authentication and multiple users per supplier organisation. PHASE 2
- Notifications by email and SMS for new bookings, changes and cancellations. PHASE 2
- Messaging thread with the Minara operations team, tied to specific bookings. PHASE 2
- Performance view — bookings received, guest ratings and response times. PHASE 3
- Settlement through a supplier wallet, with earnings accruing and payouts on schedule. PHASE 3

SECTION 16

Travel Agent & Partner Portal

A business-to-business channel. Agencies worldwide can sell Minara trips to their own clients, which multiplies reach without multiplying marketing spend.

Agent capabilities

- Application and approval process, with tiering by volume or agreement. PHASE 2
- Agent-specific net rates and commission percentages, configurable per agent or tier. PHASE 2
- Booking on behalf of a named client, with the client's details held on the booking. PHASE 2
- Quote generation branded either as Minara or as the agent, exportable to PDF. PHASE 2
- Commission dashboard: earned, pending, paid, and per-booking breakdown. PHASE 2
- Agent wallet holding commission balance, with scheduled payout or offset against future bookings. PHASE 3
- Statements and invoices downloadable for any period. PHASE 2
- Multiple staff logins under one agency account with internal permissions. PHASE 2
- Marketing resources: imagery, itinerary sheets, brochures and co-branded materials. PHASE 3
- Credit terms with a limit, so agents can book before paying. PHASE 3

Corporate clients

- Company account with multiple bookers and travellers. PHASE 3
- Approval workflow — a booking request routed to a manager before it is confirmed. PHASE 3
- Cost centre and project code tagging on every booking. PHASE 3
- Consolidated monthly invoicing and spend reporting. PHASE 3
- Negotiated corporate rates and travel-policy enforcement. FUTURE

> **GROWTH LEVER**
>
> White-label capability — an agent's clients book through a Minara-powered site carrying the agent's branding — is the natural extension of this portal, and turns each partner into a distribution channel rather than just a reseller. FUTURE

SECTION 17

Content Management

The marketing team must be able to change anything a customer reads or sees, at any time, without a developer and without risk of breaking the site.

What is editable

- All page copy, headings, calls to action and button labels. LAUNCH
- Home page composition — which collections, packages and destinations appear, and in what order. LAUNCH
- Navigation menus, footers and legal pages. LAUNCH
- Blog posts, guides and destination narratives, with a rich editor supporting images, video, quotes and internal links. LAUNCH
- Every product record — packages, hotels, activities, transfers. LAUNCH
- Frequently asked questions, policies and terms. LAUNCH
- Email and message templates. LAUNCH
- Promotional banners with scheduled start and end dates. PHASE 2

Media library

- Central library for all images and video with folders, tags and search. LAUNCH
- Automatic resizing and format optimisation so large photographs never slow the site. LAUNCH
- Alternative text and captions on every image for accessibility and search. LAUNCH
- Photo credit and usage-rights fields. PHASE 2
- Bulk upload with drag and drop. LAUNCH

Editorial workflow

- Draft, preview and publish states — nothing goes live by accident. LAUNCH
- Scheduled publishing and automatic unpublishing. PHASE 2
- Revision history with the ability to restore a previous version. PHASE 2
- Review and approval before publication for regulated content such as terms and pricing. PHASE 2
- Per-page search settings: title, description, social image and canonical address. LAUNCH
- Managed redirects when a page address changes, so no link ever breaks. LAUNCH

SECTION 18

Reviews & Reputation

In travel, social proof converts better than any marketing copy. Reviews must be genuine, visible, and answerable.

- Automatic review invitation sent after trip completion, by email and push, with a single-click entry point. LAUNCH
- Only verified travellers who completed a booking can review it. LAUNCH
- Overall rating plus sub-ratings for guides, accommodation, vehicles, value and organisation. LAUNCH
- Written review with photo upload. LAUNCH
- Moderation queue — staff approve, reject with a reason, or request edits before publication. LAUNCH
- Public reply from Minara on any review. LAUNCH
- Reviews displayed on the relevant package, hotel, destination and home page, with aggregate scores. LAUNCH
- Filter and sort reviews by rating, date, traveller type and destination. PHASE 2
- Structured data so review scores appear in search-engine results. LAUNCH
- Internal-only feedback route for issues the traveller wants resolved privately rather than published. PHASE 2
- Import and display of reviews from external platforms. PHASE 3
- Supplier-level review scores feeding the operations team's quality view. PHASE 3

SECTION 19

Messaging & Notifications

Travellers are anxious between paying and departing. Proactive, well-timed, well-written communication is the single cheapest way to reduce support load and increase satisfaction.

Channels

CHANNEL	USED FOR
Email	Confirmations, invoices, documents, itineraries, marketing, long-form updates. Branded and mobile-friendly.
SMS	Time-critical alerts where email may not be seen — driver arrival, urgent changes, verification codes.
WhatsApp	Conversational support and trip updates, the preferred channel in many of Minara's markets.
Push	App users: balance due, live trip updates, today's plan, wallet movements.
In-app / on-site	Message threads tied to a booking, plus a notification centre with read state.
Live chat	Pre-sale questions on the website, with handoff to a human and full history retained.

Automated messages

- Account: welcome, email verification, password reset, security alerts. LAUNCH
- Enquiry: acknowledgement, proposal ready, proposal expiring, follow-up sequence. LAUNCH
- Booking: provisional hold created, hold expiring, confirmation, amendment confirmed, cancellation confirmed. LAUNCH
- Payment: receipt, deposit received, balance reminder at scheduled intervals before the due date, overdue notice, failed-payment retry. LAUNCH
- Wallet: top-up received, payment made, refund credited, withdrawal requested, withdrawal completed. LAUNCH
- Pre-departure: document requests, passport-expiry warnings, packing guidance, final travel pack, arrival instructions. LAUNCH
- During travel: daily plan, driver assigned, schedule change, weather alert. PHASE 2
- Post-travel: thank you, review request, photos ready, next-trip offer. LAUNCH
- Internal alerts to staff: new booking, failed payment, expiring hold, negative review, refund awaiting approval. LAUNCH

How messaging behaves

- Every template is editable by staff, with merge fields, live preview and a test send. LAUNCH

- Messages sent in the recipient's language and scheduled sensibly for their timezone. LAUNCH
- A full communication log on every customer and booking — who was sent what, when, and whether it was delivered and opened. LAUNCH
- Granular unsubscribe: a customer can opt out of marketing while still receiving essential trip messages. LAUNCH
- Delivery failure handling with fallback to an alternative channel. PHASE 2
- Two-way conversation threads — a customer replying to a message lands in the console, not a shared inbox. PHASE 2

SECTION 20

Marketing & Growth

Features that bring travellers in, convert them, and bring them back. Each of these should be operable by the marketing team without engineering support.

Promotions and discounts

- Promotional codes with percentage or fixed value, usage limits per code and per customer, validity dates, and minimum spend. LAUNCH
- Restriction by destination, package, travel date, booking date, market or customer segment. LAUNCH
- Automatic promotions applied without a code — early-bird, last-minute, long-stay, group size. PHASE 2
- Seasonal sale campaigns with countdown banners and dedicated landing pages. PHASE 2
- Wallet credit as a promotional reward rather than a discount, keeping value inside the platform. LAUNCH
- Full reporting on redemption and the revenue impact of each promotion. PHASE 2

Acquisition and retention

- Referral programme: unique link per customer, reward to both sides on a qualifying booking, tracked end to end. PHASE 2
- Newsletter with segmented lists and campaign scheduling. PHASE 2
- Automated lifecycle campaigns — abandoned cart, browse abandonment, post-trip re-engagement, birthday and anniversary. PHASE 3
- Loyalty programme with tiers, points earned on spend, and redeemable benefits. PHASE 3
- Gift vouchers purchasable for any amount, redeemable to wallet. PHASE 2
- Wedding, honeymoon and group registries where guests contribute toward a trip. PHASE 3

Discoverability

- Search-engine fundamentals across every page and product, with editable metadata and structured data for tours, hotels, prices, availability and reviews. LAUNCH
- Fast page loading and clean addresses, both of which materially affect search ranking. LAUNCH
- Multi-language pages correctly declared to search engines. PHASE 2
- Social sharing previews with correct image, title and description on every page. LAUNCH
- Campaign tracking on every inbound link, attributed through to booking and revenue. LAUNCH
- Conversion and advertising tracking integration, respecting consent. LAUNCH
- Product feeds for advertising and comparison platforms. PHASE 3
- A/B testing of pages, prices and calls to action. FUTURE

SECTION 21

Reporting & Analytics

The business should be able to answer any commercial question from the platform itself, without exporting to spreadsheets.

Commercial reporting

- Revenue by period, product, destination, market, channel and currency. LAUNCH
- Gross margin per booking and per product, comparing supplier cost against sell price. LAUNCH
- Bookings and passenger numbers over time, with comparison to the previous period and prior year. LAUNCH
- Forward order book — revenue already committed for future months, essential for cash planning. LAUNCH
- Average booking value, lead time from booking to travel, and party size distribution. LAUNCH
- Cancellation and amendment rates, with reasons. PHASE 2

Demand and product

- Best and worst performing packages, hotels and destinations. LAUNCH
- Departure fill rates and capacity utilisation. LAUNCH
- Search and view data — what people looked for, including searches that returned nothing, which reveals demand Minara cannot yet serve. PHASE 2
- Seasonality patterns by destination and source market. PHASE 2
- Hotel source performance — direct versus aggregated inventory, by margin and conversion. PHASE 2

Financial and wallet

- Payments received by method, currency and provider, with fees. LAUNCH
- Outstanding balances and overdue receivables by age. LAUNCH
- Refunds issued, by reason. LAUNCH
- Wallet report: total liability, top-ups, spend, withdrawals, promotional credit outstanding, and expiry forecast. LAUNCH
- Supplier payables and agent commissions due. PHASE 2
- Tax summaries by jurisdiction. PHASE 2

Funnel and marketing

- Conversion funnel from visit through search, product view, checkout start and booking. PHASE 2
- Enquiry-to-booking conversion by source, product and staff member. LAUNCH
- Campaign attribution through to confirmed revenue. LAUNCH

- Customer acquisition cost and lifetime value by channel. PHASE 3
- Repeat-booking rate and referral performance. PHASE 2

How reports work

- Interactive dashboards with date-range selection and drill-down to the underlying bookings. LAUNCH
- Every report exportable to spreadsheet and PDF. LAUNCH
- Saved report configurations and scheduled email delivery to management. PHASE 2
- Role-based visibility so staff see only the figures relevant to them. LAUNCH

SECTION 22

Going Global

Minara sells to the world. The platform must feel native to a customer in Nairobi, Nuremberg, New York or Nagoya — not like a local site that happens to accept foreign cards.

Currency

- Prices displayed in the visitor's currency, detected automatically and changeable at any time. LAUNCH
- A defined base currency for accounting, with all transactions recorded in both the charged and base currency at the rate used. LAUNCH
- Exchange rates updated automatically on a schedule, with a configurable margin and the option to fix rates manually for stability. LAUNCH
- Rounding rules per currency so prices look deliberate rather than converted. LAUNCH
- The charging currency stated unambiguously before payment. LAUNCH
- Multi-currency wallet balances held separately. LAUNCH

Language and locale

- Full interface translation, with English at launch and further languages added without code changes. LAUNCH
- Priority languages: French, German, Spanish, Italian, Arabic and Chinese, driven by source-market data. PHASE 2
- Translated content — packages, destinations, articles — managed alongside the original. PHASE 2
- Right-to-left layout support for Arabic. PHASE 2
- Correct date, time, number and address formats per locale. LAUNCH
- Measurement units — kilometres or miles, Celsius or Fahrenheit — by preference. PHASE 2

Regional operation

- Timezone-correct display of all times, with the traveller's local time and the destination time both shown where relevant. LAUNCH
- Office hours and support availability shown in the visitor's timezone. LAUNCH
- Region-specific tax handling and invoice formats. PHASE 2
- Payment methods surfaced by market, so a German visitor sees the methods Germans use. PHASE 2
- Country-specific legal and consent requirements applied automatically. LAUNCH
- Regional phone numbers and support contacts. LAUNCH

SECTION 23

Trust, Security & Compliance

The platform handles passports, payment details and customer money. Security is not a feature to add later — it is a precondition for operating at all.

Protecting data

- All traffic encrypted in transit; sensitive data encrypted at rest. LAUNCH
- Passport numbers, identity documents and medical information stored with restricted access and masked in most views. LAUNCH
- Payment card data never touches Minara systems — handled entirely by certified payment providers. LAUNCH
- Role-based access with least privilege as the default. LAUNCH
- Automated, tested backups with a defined recovery procedure. LAUNCH
- Data retention policy with automated purging of records past their retention period. PHASE 2

Privacy law

- Compliance with European data protection rules, Kenya's Data Protection Act, and equivalent regimes in other markets served. LAUNCH
- Explicit, granular consent capture with a record of what was consented to and when. LAUNCH
- Self-service data download and account deletion. LAUNCH
- Cookie consent with genuine opt-out that actually suppresses tracking. LAUNCH
- A register of where personal data flows, for accountability. PHASE 2
- Breach detection and a documented notification procedure. PHASE 2

Fraud and abuse

- Fraud screening on payments with risk scoring and manual review of flagged transactions. LAUNCH
- Velocity limits on bookings, top-ups and withdrawals from one account or device. LAUNCH
- Identity verification before significant wallet withdrawals. LAUNCH
- Anti-automation protection on registration, login, enquiry and payment forms. LAUNCH
- Suspicious-activity alerts to staff, and account suspension tools. LAUNCH
- Anti-money-laundering monitoring and reporting on wallet activity. PHASE 2

Operational security

- Two-factor authentication enforced for every staff and supplier account. LAUNCH
- Immutable audit trail of every consequential action. LAUNCH

- Automatic session expiry and forced re-authentication for sensitive operations. LAUNCH
- Approval thresholds — refunds, withdrawals and discounts above a limit require a second person. LAUNCH
- Independent security testing before launch and periodically thereafter. LAUNCH
- Uptime and error monitoring with alerting to the technical team. LAUNCH

Travel-specific obligations

- Clear presentation of booking terms, with recorded acceptance at the point of purchase. LAUNCH
- Accurate, non-misleading pricing including all compulsory charges. LAUNCH
- Tourism regulator licence details displayed as required. LAUNCH
- Insurance requirements communicated before travel. LAUNCH
- Emergency contact and duty-of-care information available to every traveller at all times. LAUNCH

SECTION 24

Integrations

The platform is the centre, but it must connect outward. Each integration should be replaceable — no single provider should be so embedded that switching becomes impossible.

AREA	PURPOSE	PHASE
Stripe	Global card acceptance, digital wallets, regional payment methods, 3-D Secure, saved cards, refunds, dispute handling and payouts.	Launch
M-Pesa	East African mobile money — collection, confirmation, automatic booking reconciliation and refunds to the customer's number.	Launch
Bank payouts	Wallet withdrawals and supplier settlement to bank accounts, alongside the M-Pesa and Stripe payout routes.	Launch
Hotel supply	Wholesale accommodation inventory giving worldwide coverage.	Launch
Channel manager	Keeping contracted property availability synchronised across channels.	Phase 2
Email delivery	Reliable transactional and marketing email with delivery tracking.	Launch
SMS & WhatsApp	Time-critical alerts and conversational support.	Launch
Push notifications	Mobile app messaging.	Launch
Maps & places	Location search, maps, distance calculation, place autocomplete.	Launch
Currency rates	Daily exchange-rate feed.	Launch
Analytics	Web and app behaviour, conversion tracking, campaign attribution.	Launch
Advertising platforms	Conversion feedback for paid acquisition, consent-respecting.	Launch
Live chat	Pre-sale and support conversations on site and in app.	Launch
Review platforms	Collecting and syndicating verified traveller reviews.	Phase 2
Accounting	Export of invoices, payments and ledger entries to the finance system.	Phase 2
Travel insurance	Quoting and issuing policies at checkout.	Phase 2
Weather	Destination forecasts and pre-departure alerts.	Phase 2
Flights	Schedule lookup, status tracking, and eventually booking.	Phase 3
Identity verification	Document checks for wallet withdrawals and high-value bookings.	Phase 2
Vehicle tracking	Live location of vehicles during trips.	Phase 3

ALSO REQUIRED

An **outward-facing interface** so partners and agents can connect their own systems to Minara — checking availability, creating bookings and retrieving status programmatically. This becomes essential as the agent channel grows. PHASE 3

SECTION 25

Quality & Performance

Requirements that apply to everything rather than to any single feature. These are what separate a platform that works from one that merely demonstrates.

Speed

- Pages load and become usable in under two seconds on a normal mobile connection.
- Hotel search returns first results within three seconds even when several supply sources are being queried.
- Images optimised and delivered from locations near the visitor, wherever in the world they are.
- Performance measured continuously from multiple regions, not only from the office.

Reliability

- Target availability of 99.9% or better, monitored and reported.
- Failure of a third-party service degrades gracefully — if one hotel source is down, results still appear from the others.
- Payment operations are resilient: a network failure mid-payment never results in a charge without a booking, or a booking without a charge.
- Scheduled maintenance communicated in advance and performed in low-traffic windows for the primary markets.

Scale

- Capable of handling seasonal peaks and campaign spikes without degradation.
- Supports concurrent booking of limited inventory without ever overselling.
- Storage and search remain fast as the catalogue grows into thousands of products and hundreds of thousands of bookings.

Usability and accessibility

- Meets recognised accessibility standards — usable with a keyboard alone and with a screen reader.
- Readable at small sizes and in bright outdoor light.
- Errors explained in plain language with a clear path forward, never a technical code.
- Destructive actions confirmed, and reversible wherever possible.

Maintainability

- Automated testing covering booking, payment and wallet flows in particular.
- Separate environments for development, testing and live operation.
- Ability to release changes frequently and safely, with the ability to roll back.
- Documentation for staff, suppliers and agents, plus technical handover documentation.

- Structured logging and error reporting so problems are found before customers report them.

SECTION 26

Delivery Roadmap

A sequence designed so Minara can take real bookings and real money as early as possible, then deepen the platform against evidence from actual customers rather than assumption.

Phase 1 — Launch

Goal: a complete, credible, revenue-generating platform. Everything needed to sell a trip to a stranger in another country and deliver it well.

- Public website: home, destinations, packages, company and trust pages, blog, contact.
- Safari and tour catalogue with search, filtering, availability and detail pages.
- Park and reserve directory, automated park-fee calculation by residency and age, and quota-controlled permits.
- Game drives, balloon safaris, walking safaris and in-park activities as bookable products.
- Hotel booking engine with direct and aggregated inventory, search, rates and confirmation.
- Transfers, activities and extras.
- Custom trip enquiry and staff-built proposals.
- Booking engine: cart, holds, checkout, amendments, cancellations, documents.
- Payments: Stripe for cards, digital wallets and regional methods; M-Pesa for East Africa; bank transfer; deposits and balances.
- Travel wallet: top-up, spend, refund credit, withdrawal, statements, controls.
- Traveller accounts with trips, documents, profile and preferences.
- Mobile apps for iOS and Android including offline itineraries.
- Operations console: bookings, customers, inventory, pricing, operations, finance, configuration.
- Content management and media library.
- Reviews with moderation.
- Messaging across email, SMS, WhatsApp and push.
- Core reporting.
- Multi-currency, English interface, security and compliance foundations.

Phase 2 — Depth

Goal: reduce manual work, open new channels, and act on what the first months of data reveal.

- Supplier and property portal.
- Travel agent portal with net rates and commissions.
- Instalment plans, split payments and corporate invoicing.
- Wallet savings goals, gifting and currency conversion.
- Additional languages and regional payment methods.

- Referral programme, gift vouchers, automatic promotions and campaign tools.
- Travel insurance and visa assistance at checkout.
- Advanced reporting, saved reports and scheduled delivery.
- Map-based search, comparison, and abandoned-checkout recovery.
- Fleet, guide and driver management; supplier settlement.
- Accounting export and identity verification.

Phase 3 — Scale

Goal: compete with global platforms and build durable advantage.

- Loyalty programme with tiers and points.
- Group trip pots, wallet transfers, and wedding or honeymoon registries.
- International flight search and booking.
- Corporate accounts with approvals and cost centres.
- Partner interface for programmatic booking.
- Personalised recommendations and lifecycle marketing automation.
- Live vehicle tracking and in-trip operations.
- Wildlife logs, photo journals and richer in-app trip experiences.
- Agent credit terms and marketing resource centre.

Beyond

- White-label platform for agents and partners.
- Self-service drag-and-drop itinerary building for travellers.
- A/B testing and dynamic pricing.
- Single sign-on and travel-policy enforcement for corporate clients.

What to decide first

Three decisions shape everything that follows and should be settled before build begins:

1 · Hotel supply. Which aggregation partner provides worldwide inventory, and on what commercial terms. This determines the shape of the entire hotel product.

2 · Payment accounts. Stripe and M-Pesa are the chosen rails. What remains is opening the accounts, completing business verification, confirming settlement currencies and payout timing, and agreeing which entity receives funds in each market.

3 · Wallet regulation. Which jurisdictions Minara will hold customer funds in, and what licensing that requires. This is a legal question with a hard deadline — it must be resolved before withdrawals go live.

SECTION 27

Glossary

Shared vocabulary, so that everyone involved in building and running the platform means the same thing by the same word.

TERM	MEANING
Package	A pre-defined, sellable trip with a fixed itinerary, inclusions and price structure.
Departure	A specific dated instance of a package, with its own capacity and availability.
Itinerary	The day-by-day plan of a trip, whether pre-defined or tailor-made.
Rate plan	A priced offer for a room type, carrying its own board basis, cancellation terms and restrictions.
Board basis	What meals are included — room only, bed & breakfast, half board, full board, all inclusive.
Park fee	The government charge for entering a national park, varying by residency, age, vehicle and duration.
Conservancy fee	A separate levy charged by a private or community conservancy, set independently of government park fees.
Residency tier	The fee category a traveller falls into — citizen, regional resident or non-resident — which materially changes park pricing.
Permit	Dated, named, quota-limited authorisation for a restricted activity such as gorilla trekking or a mountain route.
Quota	The hard daily cap on how many permits an authority issues, which cannot be exceeded.
Game drive	A guided wildlife-viewing excursion by vehicle within a park or conservancy.
Circuit	A route linking several parks into one itinerary, constrained by realistic driving times.
Allocation	Rooms or seats contractually held for Minara to sell without asking the supplier each time.
Stop-sell	A block preventing sale of a product or date, usually because the supplier has closed out.
Hold	Inventory temporarily reserved during checkout or pending a deposit, which expires automatically.
Provisional	A booking with inventory held but no payment received, awaiting a deposit.
Deposit	The initial part-payment that confirms a booking; the remainder is the balance.
Voucher	The document a traveller presents to a supplier as proof of a paid booking.
Wallet	A customer's stored value on the platform, usable for bookings and withdrawable subject to policy.
Ledger	The complete, unalterable record of every value movement, from which balances are derived.
Wallet liability	The total value of customer funds Minara currently holds and owes.
Net rate	The price offered to an agent, before their commission or markup.

TERM	MEANING
Markup	The amount added to supplier cost to arrive at the customer price.
Direct inventory	Accommodation contracted by Minara directly with the property.
Aggregated inventory	Accommodation supplied through a wholesale partner, giving global reach.
Single supplement	The extra charge when a traveller occupies a room alone.
Lead time	The gap between when a booking is made and when travel occurs.
Order book	Revenue already committed for future travel dates.

NEXT STEP

Review this document and mark each feature as **agreed**, **changed** or **removed**. The Launch scope in Section 26 is the working definition of the first release — anything added to it moves the launch date, and anything removed from it should be consciously deferred rather than forgotten.